



ILORIN STARTUP ACCELERATOR PROGRAM

JANUARY 2021

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Introduction

The Ilorin Startup Accelerator Program is designed to quickly scale technology startups within Kwara State to a point where they can continue to grow on their own.

The program has two cohorts a year and each cohort will accept ten startups making twenty startups a year.

First Cohort Feb 2021 – May 2021

Second Cohort August 2021 – November 2021

The startups will go through an extensive training program, regular virtual meetings with mentors, gain access to professional business services like accounting, HR, legal and seed funding. In return, the Ilorin Innovation Hub will take 8% ownership of the company.

The areas of focus are Fintech, Agriculture, Education, Transportation, Government, Business process, E-Commerce & Logistics, Artificial Intelligence, Energy and Blockchain.

Structure & Operations

The program will have the following parties involved:

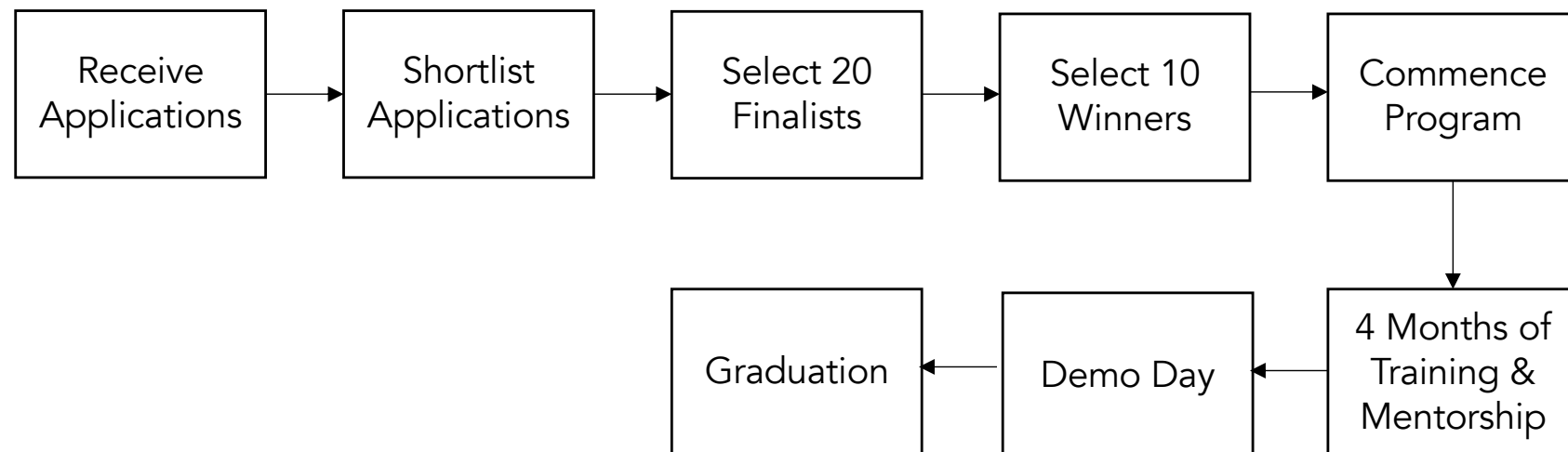
1. **Startup Teams** – they are the main reason for the program, and will learn how to grow and scale their business while improving their product.
2. **Program Manager** (Ilorin Innovation Hub)
3. **Advisors** – these are the people to conduct the selection process and judge the Demo Day pitches along with the Investors.
4. **Mentors** (one for each industry the startups enrolled are in)
5. **Partners** – these are parties that will offer free resources and benefits to the startups e.g. Google, Facebook, Twilio, Sendgrid, Mailchimp etc.
6. **Investors** – These are the investors that will be present at the end of the program for the Demo Day pitches. They will be invited to join the Ilorin Angel Network.

Application & Selection Process

The application form for the Ilorin Startup Accelerator Program will be available on F6S at <https://www.f6s.com/ilorinstartupaccelerator2021cohort1> for startups to complete and submit.

The F6S platform has several robust features to handle the entire application and selection process. All of our team members, mentors and startups will be on the platform. F6S also creates exposure for our selected startups to more investors and accelerator programs from across the globe.

The stages in the process for each cohort are:



Application & Selection Process

The criteria for selection of startups are:

1. **Idea & Technology (10 marks)** - Innovativeness of an idea, unique value proposition, unfair advantage from competition and intellectual property.
2. **Quality of Team (25 marks)** - Number of founders, their competences and experience and how long they have been working together.
3. **Market Potential (20 marks)** - Market size and market growth, is the company targeting local or global markets, what are the entrance obstacles and similar.
4. **Minimum Viable Product & Traction (20 marks)** - Does the company already have a minimum viable product or a prototype, early evangelists (first customers) and other proofs of idea validation?
5. **Business Model (15 marks)** - Does a company have a viable and profitable business model, including a defined supply chain, distribution channels, marketing and customer relationship strategy, partners, resources, activities, revenue streams and cost structure?
6. **Quality of Pitch (10 marks)** - How well did a startup team prepare the pitch, were they confident, professional and made a good impression that they can execute their plan?

Application & Selection Process

The purpose of the initial application screening process is to eliminate the ones that don't fit the basic criteria. Examples of basic criteria that need to be met, otherwise applications are eliminated immediately:

- The age or stage of the startup (less than 3 years, for example)
- Industries that are not targeted by the accelerator (traditional industries, for example)
- Commitment of founders (not fully committed or not prepared to move to another location)
- Private investors (we will prefer our startups not yet have any investors)
- Additional criteria when public funds are provided (funding schemes maximums, at least one person formally employed in the company, planned use of proceeds etc.)

The applications that don't fit the basic criteria can be excluded immediately, without judges even seeing them. A formal rejection with an explanation will be provided to the teams.

Partners & Resources

The program is partnering with the following organizations and sponsors to expand the reach of the applications received and also to create more awareness/opportunity for the member startups.

Some will also assist with the training and resources required by the startups.



Partners & Resources

The program has secured sponsorship of free resources for member startups from but not limited to the companies on the list below:



20% off



Up to \$25k in AWS Web Hosting



\$500 SMS Credit



\$1000 Email Credit



\$50 Cloud Hosting



6 months free



6 months free CRM



Free from beta to \$50k revenue



3 months free pro plan



\$44 off

Training

The startup teams will be taken through a training program that will coach them on all the various aspects of running a technology company like:

Launch

Build a great team

Product development

Understand the external environment

Know the target market

Grow

Marketing and business development

Deconstruct the business model

Strategic partnerships

Build traction

Raising Money

Fundraise for the business

Pitch your business

Prepare financials, contracts and legal

Legal

Legal basics

Funding concepts explained

The training is meant to kickstart their business while formally teaching them how to grow beyond the program, raising more money and becoming successful.

Mentors & Advisers

The program will have a selection committee, which will consist of successful entrepreneurs, mentors, startup ecosystem representatives and other experts. Our tentative list of Mentors for the program are:

- | | |
|---------------------|---|
| 1. Ayodeji Adewunmi | Former Jobberman Founder, Gokada |
| 2. Gossy Nkanwoke | CEO Betking |
| 3. Oo Nwoye | Founder Techcircle |
| 4. Adekunle Ajiboye | Aajimatics |
| 5. Osagie Alonge | Director Marketing, OPay |
| 6. Dino Miele | Spark Niagara |
| 7. Opeyemi Awoyemi | Former Jobberman, Whogohost, Indeed.com |
| 8. Joel Ogunsola | Partner Prunedge |
| 9. Mohammed Brimah | KWASIP |
| 10. Wadami Amolegbe | Conveyner Kwara Education Summit & Kwaralearn |
| 11. Ife Adebayo | SA Innovation to the VP |

Mentors will be remunerated via an equity pool created by the Innovation Hub.

Funding

Each participant in the program will be funded between N2million and N5million depending on their performance and opportunity.

They will also be trained on how to position their startup for further funding and this will start at their Demo/Graduation day.

The goal is for these startups to grow beyond the Ilorin/Kwara market and become very viable businesses that will return revenue for the Kwara State Government.